

Edgar Markov — Vampire Aristocrats

Bracket 3 · 3/3 Game Changers · no infinite combos · 100 cards · vampire upgrade pass 2026-08-06

Creatures 37	Cheap (MV≤2) 14	Avg creature MV 3.08	Lifelink 9	Draw 9	Sac outlets 5	Removal 6	Protection 2
Wipes 2	Lands 36 (7 basic)	Sources W21 / B28 / R16	Rocks 4				

COMMANDER (1)

1 Edgar Markov 3 2 1 6

RAMP & COST REDUCTION (8)

1 Arcane Signet 2 2
1 Ashnod's Altar 3 3
1 Herald's Horn 3 3
1 Patchwork Banner 3 3
1 Smothering Tithe 3 * 4
1 Sol Ring 1 1
1 Talisman of Hierarchy 2 2
1 Urza's Incubator 3 3

LANDS (36)

1 Ancient Tomb
1 Blazemire Verge
1 Blood Crypt
1 Bojuka Bog
1 Cabal Coffers
1 Castle Locthwain
1 Cavern of Souls
1 Caves of Koilos
1 Command Tower
1 Dragonskull Summit
1 Eiganjo, Seat of the Empire
1 Godless Shrine
1 Isolated Chapel
1 Luxury Suite
1 Minas Tirith
1 Mountain
1 Nomad Outpost
1 Path of Ancestry
1 Phyrexian Tower
2 Plains
1 Sacred Foundry
1 Savai Triome
1 Shattered Sanctum
1 Spectator Seating
1 Sulfurous Springs
1 Sundown Pass
4 Swamp
1 Takenuma, Abandoned Mire
1 Three Tree City
1 Urborg, Tomb of Yawgmoth
1 Vault of Champions
1 Vault of the Archangel

CARD DRAW & TUTORS (6)

1 Black Market Connections 2 3
1 Deadly Dispute 1 2
1 Emeritus of Woe 3 1 1 4
1 Florian, Voldaren Scion 1 2 3
1 Plumb the Forbidden 1 2
1 Scheming Silvertongue 1 1 1 2

REMOVAL (6)

1 Anowon, the Ruin Sage 3 3 5
1 Chaos Warp 2 3
1 Generous Gift 2 * 3
1 Path to Exile * 1
1 Ruthless Lawbringer 1 * 3
1 Swords to Plowshares * 1

BOARD WIPES (2)

1 Olivia's Wrath 4 5
1 The Meathook Massacre X 3 2

PROTECTION (2)

1 Akroma's Will 3 * 4
1 Teferi's Protection 2 * 3

THEME / SYNERGY — VAMPIRES & PAYOFFS (39)

1 Blade of the Bloodchief 1 1
1 Blood Artist 1 2
1 Bloodletter of Aclazotz 1 1 1 4
1 Bloodline Keeper 2 3 4
1 Captivating Vampire 1 3 3
1 Charismatic Conqueror 1 * 2
1 Clavileño, First of the Blessed 1 * 3
1 Cordial Vampire 3 2
1 Cruel Celebrant * 2
1 Dictate of Erebos 3 3 5
1 Dusk Legion Duelist 1 * 2
1 Edgar, Charmed Groom 2 * 4
1 Elenda, the Dusk Rose 2 * 4
1 Elspeth, Storm Slayer 3 * 5
1 Indulgent Aristocrat 1
1 Knight of the Ebon Legion 1
1 Legion Lieutenant * 2
1 Malakir Bloodwitch 3 3 5
1 Marauding Blight-Priest 2 3
1 Master of Dark Rites 1
1 Mirkwood Bats 3 4
1 Nullpriest of Oblivion 1 2
1 Phyrexian Reclamation 1
1 Purphoros, God of the Forge 3 4
1 Roaming Throne 4 4
1 Sanctum Seeker 2 3 4
1 Sangromancer 2 3 4
1 Sanguine Bond 3 3 5
1 Shared Animosity 2 3
1 Stromkirk Captain 1 2 3
1 Tainted Remedy 2 3
1 Twilight Prophet 2 3 4
1 Vampire Socialite 1 2
1 Vein Ripper 3 3 3 6
1 Vengeful Bloodwitch 1 2
1 Viscera Seer 1
1 Vito, Thorn of the Dusk Rose 2 3
1 Warleader's Call 1 2 * 3
1 Yahenni, Undying Partisan 2 3

Build history — 37 substitutions made to finalize this list

IN 	Ancient Tomb land GAME CHANGER. {T}: add {C}{C}, deals 2 damage to you.	Mountain basic {T}: Add {R}.	OUT 
Why: Only 8 red pips in the whole deck, all single — three dedicated Mountains was over-supply. NOTE: Ancient Tomb costs 2 life per tap, the same objection that ruled out Necropotence and Bolas's Citadel; affordable here because lifelink is now 11, but watch it.		Bring back: If red sources drop below ~15.	
IN 	Anowon, the Ruin Sage {3}{B}{B} 4/3 Vampire. Your upkeep: each player sacrifices a non-Vampire creature of their choice.	Cathars' Crusade {3}{W}{W} Creature enters → +1/+1 counter on your whole board.	OUT 
Why: The deck had NO recurring interaction — every answer a one-shot except Dictate. Anowon is a one-sided edict every upkeep (our board is Vampires; Roaming Throne is the chosen type, Yahenni is an Aetherborn Vampire). Roaming Throne doubles it; Dictate compounds it. It also turns on seven cards that key on opponents' creatures dying. Crusade was not a Vampire, missed both cost reducers, and was one of only two {W} {W} cards.		Bring back: If the anthem count ever drops to ≤1 and you want a counter engine back.	
IN 	Blade of the Bloodchief {1} Any creature dies → +1/+1 counter on equipped; TWO if it's a Vampire.	Idol of Oblivion {2} {T}: draw, only if you made a token. {8}: make a 10/10.	OUT 
Why: Colourless and non-Vampire. Draw now comes attached to bodies instead. Blade snowballs off deaths, which happen constantly here.		Bring back: If draw drops badly and nothing better is free.	
IN 	Cabal Coffers land {2},{T}: add {B} per Swamp — with Urborg that's ~36 black.	Swamp basic {T}: Add {B}.	OUT 
Why: Coffers counts Swamp-TYPED lands (8 → 7 after this), and Urborg makes all 36 Swamps anyway. Funding it from a Swamp instead of the last Mountain kept red on target at 16.		Bring back: Never.	
IN 	Cathars' Crusade {3}{W}{W} Creature enters → +1/+1 counter on your whole board.	Bloodthirsty Conqueror {3}{B}{B} 5/5 flying deathtouch. Opponent loses life → you gain that much.	OUT 
Why: Other half of the infinite. GENUINE LOSS — 4/6 field, and its lifegain was a real life floor (replaced by lifelink bodies instead). Crusade gives TWO triggers per Vampire cast (eminence token + the spell), THREE with Elspeth.		Bring back: Only if the table explicitly allows infinite combos.	

IN



Cavern of Souls land

Any colour for Vampires, and they CAN'T BE COUNTERED.



Unclaimed Territory land

Any colour — CREATURE SPELLS ONLY.



OUT

Why: Same creature-only problem, and Cavern does it strictly better.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Charismatic Conqueror {1}{W}

2/2 vigilance. Opponent's artifact/creature enters untapped → they tap it or you get a 1/1 lifelink Vampire.



Rakdos Signet {2}

{1},{T}: Add {B}{R}.



OUT

Why: 1/8 field — lowest adoption of anything in the deck. Conqueror is 5/6, the highest-adoption card the deck was missing.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Deadly Dispute {1}{B}

Sac an artifact or creature: draw 2 and make a Treasure.



Skullclamp {1}

Equipped creature +1/-1. When it dies, draw 2.



OUT

Why: ANTHEM-DEAD. A clamped token is 3/1 with any anthem out — it lives and draws nothing (CR 611.3c: the token is NEVER on the battlefield unmodified). Deck runs 7 anthems, and Warleader's Call pumps ALL creatures. Dispute is anthem-independent.

Bring back: If the anthem count ever drops to 1 or fewer.

IN



Emeritus of Woe {3}{B}

5/4 Vampire. Enters PREPARED → cast a copy of DEMONIC TUTOR. Re-prepares whenever 2+ creatures died that turn.



Diabolic Tutor {2}{B}{B}

Search your library for a card, put it into your hand.



OUT

Why: Four mana to find a card and affect nothing — weakest card in the 100, 0/6 field. Emeritus is a REPEATABLE tutor on a Vampire body, and it is NOT on the Game Changer list (plain Demonic Tutor is), so it costs no bracket slot.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Florian, Voldaren Scion {1}{B}{R}

3/3 first strike. Postcombat: look at top X where X = life ALL opponents lost this turn; play one that turn.



Impact Tremors {1}{R}

Creature enters → 1 damage to each opponent.



OUT

Why: Weakest of the 3 ETB-damage pieces — Warleader's Call adds an anthem, Purphoros deals 2 and is indestructible. Cost: table damage per Vampire cast drops 36 → 27. Florian is a real draw engine (X is routinely 8+).

Bring back: If the deck leans harder into tokens.

IN



Herald's Horn {3}

Vampires cost {1} less, plus top-of-library Vampire draw.



Grim Tutor {1}{B}{B}

Search library → hand. You LOSE 3 LIFE.



OUT

Why: Redundant second tutor, and 3 life is real in a deck with no life floor. Horn shifts the entire curve down a pip instead of fixing one card.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Luxury Suite land

B/R bond land — untapped with 2+ opponents.



Plains basic

{T}: Add {W}.



OUT

Why: Helps black (the starved colour, 56 pips) AND the red splash at once.

Bring back: If white sources drop below ~19.

IN



Marauding Blight-Priest {2}{B}

3/2 Vampire. Whenever you gain life, EACH opponent loses 1.



Drana, Liberator of Malakir {1}{B}{B}

2/3 flying first strike. Combat damage to a player → +1/+1 on each attacker.



OUT

Why: Survived a 66-card matrix as the single soft slot — the only card in MV1-3 whose payoff needs to CONNECT. Blight-Priest counts SOURCES not life points (CR 702.15e): 6 lifelink attackers = 6 triggers; a wipe with Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant = 6 triggers = 18 to the table.

Bring back: HELD — a fine evasive first-strike body if an MV2-4 slot opens.

IN



Markov Baron {2}{B}

Lord + lifelink, with CONVOKE — often one real mana on a wide board.



Champion of Dusk {3}{B}{B}

4/4. ETB draw X and LOSE X life, X = your Vampire count.



OUT

Why: At 15 life, X=10 kills you — this lost a real game. Field runs it 4/6, but mostly decks holding an infinite where drawing to 5 is safe because the game ends first.

Bring back: If lifelink gets high enough that drawing 8 is safe.

IN



Master of Dark Rites {B}

1/1 Vampire. {T}, sac another creature: add {B}{B} {B}. Sac outlet AND ritual.



Pitiless Plunderer {3}{B}

1/4 Human Pirate. Your creature dies → create a Treasure.



OUT

Why: Non-Vampire 4-drop. Master of Dark Rites, Phyrexian Tower, Three Tree City and Ashnod's Altar all cover 'dead creature → mana'. Trades a 4-drop for a 1-drop.

Bring back: If the deck ever wants a 6th mana outlet.

IN



Patchwork Banner {3}

Vampires +1/+1 and taps for ANY colour, painlessly.



Talisman of Indulgence {2}

{T}: {C}, or {B}/{R} for 1 damage.



OUT

Why: Pain source in a deck with 9 of them. White sources 20→21, pain 9→8, better fixing. Costs one turn of speed.

Bring back: If you need faster turn-2 ramp.

IN



Phyrexian Reclamation {B}

{1}{B}, pay 2 life: creature from graveyard → HAND. Recasting RE-TRIGGERS eminence.



Fellwar Stone {2}

Adds a colour an OPPONENT's land could produce.



OUT

Why: Unreliable — hands you blue/green you can't spend against the wrong pod (2/8 field). Reclamation is the recursion the deck had none of.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Phyrexian Tower land

{T}, sac a creature: add {B}{B}. Free sac outlet on a land.



Battlefield Forge land

{C}, or {R}/{W} for 1 damage.



OUT

Why: Fourth W/R land for a colour with only 8 single pips — AND a painland. Pain sources 9 → 8.

Bring back: If red demand ever rises.

IN



Plumb the Forbidden {1}{B}

Sac any number of creatures, copy per creature, draw 1 each.



Clever Concealment {2}{W}{W}

Convoke. Any number of your nonland permanents phase out.



OUT

Why: Protection 3 → 2, still above the 1.5 field median. Teferi's does it better and Akroma's Will is dual-mode. Plumb is anti-wipe too — sac the board in response and draw 6-8, and unlike Teferi's it beats EXILE wipes.

Bring back: Pod with heavy targeted removal.

IN



Ruthless Lawbringer {1}{W}{B}

3/2 Vampire. ETB: sac a creature → DESTROY TARGET NONLAND PERMANENT.



Welcoming Vampire {2}{W}

2/3 flier. Creatures with POWER 2 OR LESS enter → draw. Once per turn.



OUT

Why: Welcoming works with 0-1 anthems (token is 2/2) but is DEAD at two (3/3) — and Vampire Socialite's counter is a replacement effect that counts toward it. Lawbringer is a catch-all answer on a Vampire, and the sacrifice is upside (feeds Blood Artist, Celebrant, Blight-Priest).

Bring back: If anthem count drops, or draw becomes critical.

IN



Sangromancer {2}{B}{B}

3/3 flier. Whenever a creature an opponent controls dies, you may gain 3 life. Also on opponent discard.



Vampire of the Dire Moon {B}

1/1 deathtouch lifelink.



OUT

Why: Rebuilds the life floor lost when Bloodthirsty Conqueror was cut. Each death is a SEPARATE gain event, so it feeds Marauding Blight-Priest, Vito and Sanguine Bond per death — and Anowon, Dictate, Olivia's Wrath and Meathook manufacture those deaths. Dire Moon was the only vanilla card in the list, doing this job worse.

Bring back: If the curve ever needs another 1-drop body, Dire Moon returns.

IN



Savai Triome land

W/B/R, typed Plains Mountain Swamp. Enters tapped, cycles {3}.



Exotic Orchard land

Any colour an OPPONENT's land could produce.

OUT



Why: Depends entirely on the pod. Savai is reliable and its land types turn on your conditional lands AND count for Cabal Coffers.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Scheming Silvertongue {1}{B}

1/3 flying lifelink Vampire. Gained 2+ life this turn → cast a copy of SIGN IN BLOOD. Repeatable draw-2.



Terminate {B}{R}

Destroy target creature, no regeneration.

OUT



Why: Creature-only removal; Swords and Path cover it. Removal 6 → 5 = exactly median. Silvertongue hits cheap-creature count, lifelink AND draw on one \$1 card.

Bring back: Creature-heavy pod.

IN



Shattered Sanctum land

W/B. Enters tapped unless you control TWO OR MORE other lands — untapped from land drop 3 on.



Tainted Field land

{C}, or {W}/{B} only if you control a Swamp.

OUT



Why: Tainted Field could sit stuck on colourless for a long time on a slow land draw — only 7 Swamp-typed enablers, ~50% at four lands. Sanctum is guaranteed W/B from land drop 3. Tainted Field is not itself Swamp-typed, so removing it has ZERO knock-on effect on the other conditional lands.

Bring back: If you want a land that always taps for at least {C} on turns 1-2.

IN



Smothering Tithe {3}{W}

GAME CHANGER. Opponent draws → they pay {2} or you get a Treasure.



Orzhov Signet {2}

{1},{T}: Add {W}{B}.

OUT



Why: 2/8 field. Rocks cut 9 → 4 as the curve came down — rock count tracks curve height (the swarm decks run 1-3).

Bring back: If the curve ever goes back up.

IN



Sundown Pass land

R/W. Enters tapped unless you control TWO OR MORE other lands — untapped from land drop 3 on.



Clifftop Retreat land

R/W. Enters tapped unless you control a Mountain or a Plains.

OUT



Why: Clifftop needed a Mountain or Plains and had only 7 enablers — untapped just 50% of the time on your 4th land. Critically it was the ONE conditional land Urborg cannot fix (Urborg grants Swamp, not Mountain/Plains). Sundown Pass is 100% untapped from land drop 3. Same colours, pure reliability gain.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Tainted Remedy {2}{B}

If an opponent would gain life, that player loses that much life instead.



Sorin, Imperious Bloodlord {2}{B}

+1 deathtouch/lifelink · +1 sac a Vampire for 3 ·
-3 put a Vampire from hand onto the battlefield.

OUT



Why: Sorin's -3 was seated to cheat an 8-card 5-drop tier into play; that tier is gone (two legal targets remain above MV4), and -3 puts the Vampire in WITHOUT casting it — no eminence token. Tainted Remedy is a permanent answer to the pod's lifegain decks, and it flips Swords to Plowshares from 'they gain life' to 'they lose that much'.

Bring back: Tainted Remedy is a hoser — side it out against pods with no lifegain.

IN



Teferi's Protection {2}{W}

GAME CHANGER. Phase out all your permanents + protection from everything until your next turn.



Toxic Deluge {2}{B}

PAY X LIFE. All creatures get -X/-X.

OUT



Why: The one wipe that attacks the resource you're shortest on. Olivia's Wrath is one-sided and Meathook keeps draining after — two wipes is right for go-wide. Teferi's answers the wipes that kept killing your board.

Bring back: Vs go-wide opponents when you need a 3rd wipe and can afford the life.

IN



Three Tree City land

{2},{T}: mana equal to your Vampire count, in any one colour.



Plains basic

{T}: Add {W}.

OUT



Why: Scales with the board — on a wide turn it is the biggest mana source in the deck. Becomes a black source once Urborg is down.

Bring back: If white sources drop below ~19.

IN



Urborg, Tomb of Yawgmoth land

Every land is a Swamp. Black sources 28 → 42.



Secluded Courtyard land

Any colour — CREATURE SPELLS ONLY.

OUT



Why: Deck now has 28 noncreature cards, so Courtyard was colourless for nearly half the list. Urborg fixes the real problem (56 black pips vs 28 sources), turns every colourless utility land into a black source, AND switches on all four remaining basic-type conditional lands.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Urza's Incubator {3}

Vampire spells cost {2} LESS. Stacks with Herald's Horn = {3} off every Vampire.



Mind Stone {2}

{T}: Add {C}. {1},{T}, sac: draw a card.

OUT



Why: Vanilla rock with 0/8 field adoption — literally nobody runs it. Cost reduction beats a colourless rock once the curve comes down.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Vampire of the Dire Moon {B}

1/1 deathtouch lifelink. Turn-1 play that scales with every lord.



Oathsworn Vampire {1}{B}

2/2. ENTERS TAPPED. Cast from graveyard only if you gained life this turn.



OUT

Why: Does nothing the turn it lands and the recursion is conditional. Phyrexian Reclamation does that job unconditionally.

Bring back: Never.

IN



Vault of Champions land

W/B bond land — untapped with 2+ opponents, i.e. always in Commander.



Plains basic
{T}: Add {W}.



OUT

Why: White at 21 sources for 20 pips is comfortable. Bond lands are strictly better than basics in a multiplayer game.

Bring back: If white sources drop below ~19.

IN



Vault of the Archangel land

{2}{W}{B},{T}: your whole team gains DEATHTOUCH AND LIFELINK.



Mountain basic

{T}: Add {R}.



OUT

Why: Rebuilds the life floor from a LAND, costing no spell slot — the direct answer to losing lifegain races. (One Mountain was later restored off a Swamp to hold red at 16 sources.)

Bring back: If red sources drop below ~15.

IN



Vein Ripper {3}{B}{B}

6/5 flier, Ward—Sacrifice a creature. ANY creature dies → target opponent loses 2, you gain 2.



Exquisite Blood {4}{B}

Whenever an opponent loses life, you gain that much life.



OUT

Why: Half of the infinite — pairs with BOTH Sanguine Bond and Vito. Cutting this direction kills all four pairings at once. Ripper is a Vampire (lords, eminence, Roaming Throne) and its board-wide drain DETERS opponents from wiping.

Bring back: Only if the table explicitly allows infinite combos.

IN



Vengeful Bloodwitch {1}{B}

1/1. Whenever this or another creature YOU CONTROL dies, target opponent loses 1 life and you gain 1 life.



Markov Baron {2}{B}

2/2. Convoke, lifelink, other Vampires +1/+1, madness {2}{B}.



OUT

Why: Ranked all four Vampire lords instead of nominating one: Baron is the weakest. Its lifelink is on ITSELF only, its madness is DEAD (no discard outlet in the deck), and convoke saves 1-2 mana and only with untapped creatures you were not attacking with. Stromkirk grants the whole team first strike; Captivating Vampire's steal is removal (steal then sacrifice to a free outlet). The add is a 5th aristocrats drain — and since Marauding Blight-Priest counts life-gain EVENTS, it is a 5th Blight-Priest trigger per death, not just 1 more life. Curve MV3 -> MV2.

Bring back: If the anthem count ever falls below 4, Baron is the cheapest way back.

IN



Warleader's Call {1}{R}{W}

Creatures +1/+1 AND creature enters → 1 damage to each opponent.



Fracture {W}{B}

Destroy target artifact, enchantment or planeswalker.



OUT

Why: CANNOT hit creatures. Generous Gift and Chaos Warp already cover that role and removal stays at the field median of 5.

Bring back: BLOOD MOON or BACK TO BASICS in the pod — Fracture answers both. Also any heavy artifact/enchantment deck.

Sideboard — what to bring in, and when



Boros Charm {R}{W}

Bring in: Wipe-heavy pods. Note it protects ALL your permanents, not just creatures.



Coat of Arms {5}

Bring in: Only when you're the sole tribal deck at the table. SYMMETRICAL — never vs another tribal deck.



Drana and Linvala {1}{W}{W}{B}

Bring in: Facing equipment / activated-ability decks. Shuts off opponents' activated abilities AND steals them.



Drana, Liberator of Malakir {1}{B}{B}

Bring in: Ability-light pods where an evasive first-strike blocker matters more than a drain trigger.



Elenda's Hierophant {2}{W}

Bring in: Token/ETB-payoff pods. Grows on every life-gain EVENT; dies into X 1/1 lifelink Vampire tokens (X = its power, anthems included), doubled by Elspeth. Needs a sac outlet to cash in.



Fracture {W}{B}

Bring in: BLOOD MOON or BACK TO BASICS in the pod — this answers both. Also heavy artifact/enchantment decks.



Gifted Aetherborn {B}{B}

Bring in: If you need another cheap lifelink blocker.



Indulging Patrician {1}{W}{B}

Bring in: You need a clock that does not require attacking, or a real blocker while stabilising. 1/4 flying lifelink; end step, if you gained 3+ life, each opponent loses 3 — 18 with Bloodletter, 36 with Roaming Throne too.



Killing Wave {X}{B}

Bring in: Grindy pods, or to break a board stall.



Olivia Voldaren {2}{B}{R}

Bring in: The only repeatable interaction available. Costs an 11th MV4 slot — take it if the pod is creature-heavy.



Patron of the Vein {4}{B}{B}

Bring in: Grindy or creature-heavy pods, and against recursion decks — opponents' creatures that die are EXILED and every Vampire gets a +1/+1 counter. Pairs directly with Anowon. Held out of the 100 purely on curve (would be a third MV6).



Preacher of the Schism {2}{B}

Bring in: When you want anthem-independent draw. 2/4 deathtouch; attack a player with more life → draw + a 1/1 Vampire.



Village Rites {B}

Bring in: If draw proves too thin in playtesting. Sac, draw 2, instant speed.

EDGAR MARKOV — PILOT'S GAMEPLAN

How to actually play the deck, turn by turn and board state by board state. Written for the locked 100 in DECK.md .

Revised 2026-08-04 for the no-combo rebuild. There is no longer an infinite in the deck — Exquisite Blood and Bloodthirsty Conqueror are permanently sideboarded. Everything here is fair.

0. The one-paragraph version

You are **not** a creature deck that wins by connecting with attacks. You are a **damage engine that happens to have creatures**. Most of your damage never touches a blocker: Sanctum Seeker fires on *declaring* attackers, Blood Artist / Cruel Celebrant / Vein Ripper fire on *death*, Warleader's Call and Purphoros fire on *entering*, and Marauding Blight-Priest fires every time any of those gain you life. Every one of them hits all three opponents at once. Combat is how you close, not how you win. Once you internalise that, the "do I attack or hold back?" question mostly answers itself — **you attack, because attacking is what turns the engine, and the crack-back is survivable because your creatures dying is also profitable**.

1. What actually kills people, ranked

A. The drain engine (your primary and only win con). These hit *every opponent simultaneously*, which is the only way to actually beat three people:

Card	Trigger	Notes
Sanctum Seeker	each Vampire you control attacks	1 to <i>each</i> opponent, per attacker. Blockers are irrelevant
Marauding Blight-Priest	any time you gain life	1 to <i>each</i> opponent per life-gain event — count sources, not life
Cruel Celebrant	any creature/PW you control dies	1 to <i>each</i> opponent
Blood Artist	any creature dies (incl. theirs)	1 to <i>one target</i> — split across players
Vein Ripper	any creature dies	2 to one target, and you gain 2
Mirkwood Bats	you create or sacrifice a token	1 to each. Create <i>and</i> sac = 2 hits per token
Warleader's Call	a creature you control enters	1 to each, plus a team anthem
Purphoros	another creature you control enters	2 to each. Indestructible
Malakir Bloodwitch	ETB	each opponent loses = your Vampire count; you gain the total
Twilight Prophet	your upkeep (needs 10+ permanents)	each opponent loses the revealed card's mana value

B. Combat. A wide board + lords + Edgar's counters + Shared Animosity kills *one* player per swing. Use it to remove the player closest to winning, or finish someone the drains already softened.

C. There is no combo. This is deliberate. Your "I win" turn is a wide board plus **Vault of the Archangel** (team lifelink) with Blight-Priest and Vito out — every attacker is a separate life-gain event, so eight attackers is eight triggers to *each* opponent, doubled by Bloodletter on your turn.

The mental reframe: stop asking "will this attack get through?" Ask **"how many triggers does this turn generate?"**

2. Fixing your tracking problem — the two-number system

Almost everything in this deck buffs **uniformly**. Track exactly two things.

Number 1: the ANTHEM (lives in your head — one number, applies to every Vampire)

Card	Anthem
Legion Lieutenant	+1/+1
Captivating Vampire	+1/+1
Stromkirk Captain	+1/+1 (and first strike)
Markov Baron	+1/+1 (and lifelink)
Edgar, Charmed Groom	+1/+1
Patchwork Banner	+1/+1
Warleader's Call	+1/+1 (all creatures, not just Vampires)
Bloodline Keeper — <i>flipped</i> (Lord of Lineage)	+2/+2

Max stack = **+9/+9**. Say it out loud at the start of your turn: *"Everything of mine is +3/+3 right now."* Don't put dice on the board for this — it's one number, and if the lord dies it all goes away at once.

⚠ Every **Vampire** lord says "other" Vampires — no lord buffs itself. Patchwork Banner and Warleader's Call have no such restriction.

Number 2: the COUNTERS (physically on cards — these are permanent)

+1/+1 counters stay through everything, including lords dying. Sources: Edgar's attack trigger, Vampire Socialite (static + ETB), **Cathars' Crusade**, Cordial Vampire, Indulgent Aristocrat, Blade of the Bloodchief, Elspeth's 0, Sorin's +1, Knight of the Ebon Legion's end step.

The physical trick: Edgar's attack trigger, Cathars' Crusade and Cordial Vampire hit every creature equally, so your board naturally sorts into a few groups. **Lay tokens out in rows by counter count** with **one die at the head of each row**:

row A	▶ [d6 showing 3]	■ ■ ■ ■	← four tokens, 3 counters each
row B	▶ [d6 showing 1]	■ ■	← two newer tokens, 1 counter each

When Edgar attacks, bump every die by 1. New tokens start a new row.

Cathars' Crusade is the fiddliest card in the deck — it triggers on every creature entering, including each eminence token, so one Vampire cast is **two** board-wide bumps (three with Elspeth). Resolve them one at a time and bump every die each time.

Vampire Socialite closes the gap for you: while an opponent has lost life this turn (basically always), every Vampire enters with an extra +1/+1 counter — fresh tokens arrive as 2/2s.

Number 3, only during combat: SHARED ANIMOSITY

Each attacker gets **+1/+0 for each other attacking creature sharing a type**. With 9 Vampires attacking that's **+8/+0 each**. Compute it once at declare-attackers and announce the total.

3. Turn-by-turn: the opening

The single most important thing to know about your commander

Eminence works from the command zone. *"Whenever you cast another Vampire spell, if Edgar is in the command zone or on the battlefield, create a 1/1 black Vampire token."*

You do **not** need to cast Edgar to get value. He generates a free token off every Vampire spell from turn 1, from the command zone. **A turn-2 Vampire is really two bodies.**

⚠ Eminence triggers on **cast**. Reanimation (Phyrexian Reclamation returns to *hand* — that's the point) and "put onto the battlefield" effects miss it entirely.

T1–T2 — deploy cheap Vampires, always

Every one- and two-drop is a two-for-one thanks to eminence. Priority:

1 mana: Viscera Seer · Indulgent Aristocrat · Knight of the Ebon Legion · Master of Dark Rites · Vampire of the Dire Moon **2 mana:** Legion Lieutenant · Cruel Celebrant · Blood Artist · Vampire Socialite · Charismatic Conqueror · Scheming Silvertongue · Nullpriest of Oblivion · Dusk Legion Duelist · Cordial Vampire

Sol Ring or a signet is also a fine T1–T2.

T3 — the fork: engine, lord, or cost reduction?

- **Board is empty-ish** → build the base. Lord next, Sanctum Seeker the turn after.
- **2–3 bodies already** → Legion Lieutenant / Captivating Vampire / Stromkirk Captain /

Markov Baron (convoke — often costs you one real mana on a wide board).

- **Long game expected** → Herald's Horn or Urza's Incubator. Together they take **3 off every

Vampire**, which is the single biggest thing you can do to your curve. Black Market Connections is also a great T3 (draw + Treasure + a 3/2 changeling that is a Vampire).

T4–T5 — when to actually cast Edgar

Edgar on the battlefield is **4/4 first strike + haste** and *"whenever Edgar attacks, put a +1/+1 counter on each Vampire you control"* (all of them, attacking or not).

Cast him when: you have **3+ other Vampires** and intend to attack this turn or next. Three turns of attacking permanently makes your whole team +3/+3.

Hold him when: the table is packed with open mana and removal and you're getting full eminence value anyway. He has **haste**, so you lose nothing by dropping him later as a surprise finisher.

Recasting after removal: 7 mana the second time, 9 the third. Once is usually correct. He never stops working from the command zone, so a dead Edgar is a real loss but not a disaster.

Mulligans

Keep: 3+ lands with two colours, at least one 1–2 drop Vampire. **Ship:** 2 lands with no rock, 6+ lands, or no play before turn 3. You have 36 lands + 4 rocks. ⚠ Rocks are down from 9 in the old build — **you cannot keep a land-light hand expecting a signet to bail you out any more.**

4. The combat decision tree

Run this in order, every turn:

Step 1 — Is Edgar on the battlefield? Then Edgar attacks. Almost always.

His trigger puts a permanent counter on **every Vampire you control**, including the ones staying home to block. Even attacking alone into a board where he'll die, you've permanently grown the team. He's a 4/4 **first striker**, so he one-sidedly kills most 4-toughness blockers.

Only keep him home if he dies to a blocker for nothing *and* you can't afford the recast.

Step 2 — Count your payoffs. This sets your whole posture.

- **Sanctum Seeker out?** Attack with **everything that can attack**. Each attacker is 1 to each

opponent on declaration, whether or not it connects.

- **Aristocrats out (Blood Artist / Cruel Celebrant / Vein Ripper / Blight-Priest)?** Attacking is

nearly free — creatures dying is profitable.

- **Neither?** You're just attacking. Be more careful.

Step 3 — Who do you attack?

The player closest to winning, or the one whose board can't punish you. Note that Sanctum Seeker, Blight-Priest, Cruel Celebrant and Warleader's Call hit **all three regardless of who you attack**, so pick the target by what combat itself accomplishes.

Step 4 — How much do you keep home?

Keep back the cards whose value is being alive: Blood Artist (0/1), Viscera Seer (1/1), **Marauding Blight-Priest (3/2 — it must survive to keep triggering)**, Vito, Blight-Priest's fellow non-combatants. Everything with counters on it should be attacking.

Step 5 — Tokens: attack, block, or sacrifice?

Attack by default. A token that gets blocked and dies triggers Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant + Vein Ripper + Mirkwood Bats + Blight-Priest — that's ~11 life off the table for a 1/1 you got for free.

5. The sacrifice decision tree

Sacrifice when:

- You have a free outlet (Viscera Seer, Ashnod's Altar, Yahenni, **Phyrexian Tower**,

Master of Dark Rites) and any aristocrat out

- In response to targeted removal — get the value before they get the card
- In response to a **wrath** — **Plumb the Forbidden** turns your whole board into 6-8 cards, and it

beats exile-based wipes that Teferi's Protection can't stop

- To fix mana: Master of Dark Rites turns a free token into    , Phyrexian Tower into  

Do NOT sacrifice when:

- You have no aristocrat out and no mana need — you're just losing bodies
- The creature is holding counters you need for lethal
- **Blight-Priest or Vito would die in the same wipe** — they have no look-back, so they must be on

the battlefield when the life gain happens

The engine to look for

Free outlet + Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant + Blight-Priest. Each sacrificed token is 1 focused, 1 to each, and 2 more to each from Blight-Priest (two life-gain events). Roughly **13 across the table per token**, doubled on your turn by Bloodletter.

6. Sequencing — order of operations within your turn

1. **Upkeep triggers first** — Twilight Prophet, Herald's Horn, Edgar Markov's Coffin.
2. **Precombat: deploy creatures.** Every Vampire cast makes an eminence token *while the spell is

still on the stack*, so the token enters first and gets its own Cathars' Crusade trigger, then the creature enters and triggers again. Both tokens and the creature trigger Warleader's Call, Purphoros and Vampire Socialite.

- *Exception:* hold mana if you specifically want **Teferi's Protection** or **Akroma's Will** up.

1. **Attack.** Declare attackers → Sanctum Seeker, Edgar's counters, Clavileño, Shared Animosity all

resolve here, before blockers.

1. **After blockers are declared** — this is when instant-speed pumps and sacs go: Indulgent

Aristocrat, Vault of the Archangel, Akroma's Will, Plumb the Forbidden.

1. **Postcombat main** — Florian's trigger fires here. ⚠️ **Keep mana up for it**; the exiled card is playable *that turn only*.

Bloodletter of Aclazotz rewrites this

With Bloodletter out, all opponent life loss **on your turn** is doubled. Sanctum Seeker at 8 attackers becomes 16 to each. Blight-Priest doubles. Twilight Prophet doubles. Purphoros and Warleader's Call double. **Deploy Bloodletter before you attack, never after.**

7. Scenario library

✂️ Scenario 1 — wide board with aristocrats out

Attack with everything that isn't holding the engine together. Blocks that kill your tokens are *good* — each death is Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant + Vein Ripper + Blight-Priest.

🛡️ Scenario 2 — same board, no aristocrats

You're a fair creature deck this turn. Attack the open player, keep enough blockers to survive the crack-back, and spend the turn finding a payoff — Emeritus of Woe tutors, Florian digs.

💀 Scenario 3 — you're clearly the archenemy

Hold Teferi's Protection. It answers every wipe including exile effects, and it protects your whole board plus your life total for a turn cycle. If you don't have it, Plumb the Forbidden converts the board into cards instead.

🔥 Scenario 4 — a wrath resolves and you lose everything

1. Did you respond with Plumb? (You should have.)
2. Phyrexian Reclamation gets your best creature back **to hand** — recasting re-triggers eminence.
3. Nullpriest of Oblivion kicked for 3♣ reanimates directly.
4. Yahenni and Cordial Vampire may have grown enormous off the deaths.
5. Meathook and your aristocrats turned their wipe into damage — count it before conceding the turn.

👤 Scenario 5 — you want to wipe

Olivia's Wrath is one-sided — only **non-Vampires** get -X/-X. It kills your own Mirkwood Bats and Elspeth's Soldiers; everything else of yours lives. The Meathook Massacre picks X and stays on the battlefield draining afterwards. **Check Blight-Priest and Vito survive before you pick X.**

🕊️ Scenario 6 — you need to get through in the air

Fliers: Bloodline Keeper (and its 2/2 tokens), Bloodletter, Twilight Prophet, Malakir Bloodwitch (pro-white), Vein Ripper, Scheming Silvertongue, Clavileño's 4/3 Demon tokens. Akroma's Will gives the whole team flying + double strike if you control your commander.

📉 Scenario 7 — flooded on mana with nothing to do

Sinks: Knight of the Ebon Legion (2♣ for +3/+3 deathtouch), Captivating Vampire (tap five to steal), Vito (3♣♣ team lifelink), Vault of the Archangel, Cabal Coffers + Three Tree City, Castle Locthwain / Minas Tirith to draw.

👤 Scenario 8 — you're out of cards

Scheming Silvertongue (draw 2 whenever you gained 2+ life — nearly every turn), Florian, Emeritus of Woe, Deadly Dispute, Plumb the Forbidden, Black Market Connections, Twilight Prophet.

🏰 Scenario 9 — Elspeth is out

Everything doubles. Eminence makes 2 tokens per Vampire cast, which is 2 Cathars' Crusade triggers, 2 Warleader's Call triggers and 4 Purphoros damage to each opponent. Her -3 also kills any creature with MV 3+, and her 0 gives the team flying for a turn — that's often your lethal swing.

👑 Scenario 10 — Roaming Throne is out

Name **Vampire**. It doubles the triggered abilities of your other Vampire *creatures*: Sanctum Seeker, Blood Artist, Cruel Celebrant, Blight-Priest, Vein Ripper, Malakir Bloodwitch, Twilight Prophet, Cordial Vampire. ⚠️ It does **not** double eminence while Edgar is in the command zone — but it does once Edgar is on the battlefield. It also misses Mirkwood Bats (a Bat) and Purphoros / Warleader's Call (not creatures).

⌚ Scenario 11 — someone else is about to win

1. Can you kill them this turn? Count Sanctum Seeker + Blight-Priest + combat.
2. Can you remove the threat? Swords to Plowshares, Path to Exile, Chaos Warp,

Generous Gift, Ruthless Lawbringer, Elspeth's -3, Eiganjo channel, or steal it with Captivating Vampire.

- 1. Can you make them sacrifice it? Dictate of Erebos + a free outlet.

 Scenario 12 — you're at low life

This deck pays life freely — Black Market Connections, Castle Locthwain, Caves of Koilos, Sulfurous Springs, three shocks, **Ancient Tomb (2 per tap)**, Phyrexian Reclamation. It adds up. Stabilise with Vault of the Archangel (team lifelink + deathtouch), Markov Baron, Vampire of the Dire Moon, Vito's , or a Malakir Bloodwitch ETB — at 8 Vampires that gains you **48**.

8. How to count lethal

1. Sanctum Seeker	$A \times RT \times BL$	on declaring attackers
2. Warleader's Call	$C \times BL$	per creature entering this turn
3. Purphoros	$2C \times BL$	
4. Blight-Priest	$E \times BL$	E = life-gain events this turn
5. Combat damage	$\Sigma(\text{base} + K + L) + \text{Shared Animosity}$	
6. Death triggers	whatever trades	

Add 1–4 first. That's damage to **every** opponent simultaneously and it happens before blockers. Very often the table is already dead before you count combat.

9. Trigger checklist — the ones people forget

- ☐ **Eminence** on every Vampire *cast* — even countered spells
- ☐ **Cathars' Crusade** on *every* creature entering, tokens included — twice per Vampire cast
- ☐ **Warleader's Call / Purphoros** on every creature entering
- ☐ **Marauding Blight-Priest** on every *separate* life-gain event — lifelink attackers count

individually

- ☐ **Sanctum Seeker** on declaring attackers, not on damage
- ☐ **Mirkwood Bats** on create **and** sacrifice
- ☐ **Blade of the Bloodchief** on any creature dying, including opponents'
- ☐ **Vampire Socialite's** counter applies as the creature enters (replacement effect)
- ☐ **Dusk Legion Duelist** draws whenever counters land on it — Cathars' Crusade does this every turn
- ☐ **Herald's Horn / Twilight Prophet** on your upkeep
- ☐ **Florian** in your postcombat main — hold mana
- ☐ **Emeritus / Silvertongue** re-arm at end step / second main

10. Beginner mistakes to avoid

1. **Not attacking.** Sanctum Seeker pays on declaration; blockers are irrelevant.
2. **Holding tokens back to block.** Their deaths are profitable.
3. **Casting Edgar into open removal on an empty board.** He works from the command zone.
4. ****Forgetting Bloodletter doubles *before* you attack.**** Deploy it first.
5. **Wiping with Meathook without checking Blight-Priest and Vito survive.** They have no look-back.
6. **Not naming Vampire with Roaming Throne or Cavern of Souls.**
7. **Forgetting Olivia's Wrath kills your own Mirkwood Bats.**
8. **Letting Florian's exiled card expire** — it's playable that turn only.
9. **Tapping Ancient Tomb for value you don't need.** It's 2 life a pop and this deck loses races.
10. **Forgetting Urborg** turns on Cabal Coffers, Castle Locthwain, Dragonskull Summit, Isolated

Chapel and Blazemire Verge all at once.

11. What changed in the 2026-08 rebuild

The deck used to hold a four-way infinite (Exquisite Blood **or** Bloodthirsty Conqueror + Sanguine Bond **or** Vito). Both "opponent loses life → you gain life" pieces are now permanently sideboarded, which kills all four pairings while leaving Vito and Sanguine Bond in — they only convert *your* gain into *their* loss and can't loop alone.

What replaced the combo as the win condition:

Added	Job
Marauding Blight-Priest	Converts the deck's most abundant resource (lifegain) into damage to <i>all three</i> opponents
Vault of the Archangel	Team lifelink from a land — turns one alpha strike into A Blight-Priest triggers
Vein Ripper	Double Blood Artist on a 6/5 flier, and its ward deters wipes
Cathars' Crusade	Two board-wide pumps per Vampire cast, three with Elspeth
Herald's Horn + Urza's Incubator	3 off every Vampire — the real curve fix
Teferi's Protection + Plumb the Forbidden	The two answers to the wraths that kept ending games

The deck is slower to "win from nowhere" and much harder to disrupt. Games end through accumulated board presence and drain triggers rather than a two-card kill.

12. The 60-second cheat sheet

UPKEEP	Twilight Prophet · Herald's Horn · Edgar's Coffin
MAIN 1	Bloodletter FIRST if you have it Cast Vampires — each is 2 bodies (3 with Elspeth) Each cast = 2 Cathars triggers, 2 Warleader's, 4 Purphoros dmg
ATTACK	Everything that isn't holding the engine together Sanctum Seeker + Edgar counters + Shared Animosity resolve NOW
BLOCKS IN	Indulgent Aristocrat · Vault of the Archangel · Akroma's Will Plumb the Forbidden in response to a wrath
MAIN 2	FLORIAN — hold mana, the exiled card expires this turn
COUNT LETHAL:	Seeker + Warleader's + Purphoros + Blight-Priest, THEN combat
ANTHEM:	one number in your head, max +9/+9
COUNTERS:	dice at the head of each row, bump every die when Edgar attacks

EDGAR MARKOV — DAMAGE FORMULAS & MATH

Companion to `gameplan.md`. Every card in the locked 100 that produces a number, written as a formula you can evaluate at the table, then the multiplicative pairs ranked by effect.

Revised 2026-08-04 for the no-combo rebuild. The infinite is gone — Exquisite Blood and Bloodthirsty Conqueror are permanently in the sideboard. Everything below is fair damage.

1. Symbols

Symbol	Meaning
A	Attacking Vampires you control
V	Vampires you control (total, attacking or not)
D	Creatures that died — any controller
Dy	Creatures you controlled that died
Do	Creatures opponents controlled that died
C	Creatures entering under your control
T	Tokens created (before doubling)
L	Lord anthem total — the single +X/+X number
K	+1/+1 counters on a given creature
E	Life-gain EVENTS — count <i>sources</i> , not life points
P	Opponents still alive — normally 3

"Per opponent" → multiply by P for the table total. "Focusable" → the triggers target individually, so you choose who eats them.

2. The three multipliers

Multiplier	Effect	Does NOT apply to
Bloodletter of Aclazotz (BL)	×2 all opponent life loss during your turn . Damage counts as life loss.	Your life gain. Other players' turns.
Roaming Throne naming Vampire (RT)	×2 triggered abilities of your other Vampire creatures	Mirkwood Bats (a Bat), Purphoros / Warleader's Call (not creatures), eminence while Edgar is in the command zone
Elspeth, Storm Slayer (EL)	×2 every token created under your control	Tokens created under an opponent's control (Generous Gift)

They multiply independently. Sanctum Seeker with RT and BL online is **4x per opponent**.

 **Roaming Throne and eminence.** Edgar's eminence works from the command zone, but Throne only doubles "*a triggered ability of another creature you control*." In the command zone Edgar isn't one, so eminence is **not** doubled. Once Edgar is on the battlefield it **is** — two tokens per Vampire cast, and two counters on every Vampire when he attacks.

3. Drain & direct damage

Marauding Blight-Priest — the one people miscount

each opponent loses	=	E × BL	E = number of life-gain EVENTS
table total	=	E × BL × P	

Count sources, not life. Per CR 702.15e and 119.9, every separate source that causes you to gain life is its own event:

Situation	E
6 creatures with lifelink deal combat damage at once (Vault of the Archangel)	6
Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant, 3 creatures die	6 (3 + 3, each resolving separately)
One lifelink creature hits three things at once (trample / multi-block)	1
A spell that says "gain 6 life"	1
Gain 0 life	0

⚠️ Blight-Priest must be **on the battlefield when each life gain happens**. If it dies in the same wipe that triggers Blood Artist, it contributes **nothing** — "whenever you gain life" has no look-back-in-time clause.

Sanctum Seeker

each opponent loses	=	$A \times RT \times BL$
you gain	=	$A \times RT$

Fires on **declaring** attackers. Blockers, removal and fogs are all irrelevant.

Vein Ripper

target opponent loses	=	$D \times 2 \times RT \times BL$
you gain	=	$D \times 2 \times RT$

Counts **any** creature dying, opponents' included. Focusable. Ward—Sacrifice a creature means their removal feeds your own death triggers. It's a Vampire, so RT applies.

Blood Artist

focusable damage	=	$D \times RT \times BL$
you gain	=	$D \times RT$

Cruel Celebrant

each opponent loses	=	$D_y \times RT \times BL$
you gain	=	$D_y \times RT$

Only your creatures, but hits every opponent. Planeswalkers count.

Mirkwood Bats

each opponent loses	=	$(T \times EL + \text{tokens sacrificed}) \times BL$
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Triggers on **create AND sacrifice** — a token made and then sacrificed is **two** hits. ⚠️ It's a **Bat**. Roaming Throne naming Vampire misses it.

Warleader's Call

each opponent loses	=	$C \times BL$
plus	=	+1/+1 to every creature you control

Purphoros, God of the Forge

each opponent loses	=	$2C \times BL$
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"Another creature," so Purphoros entering doesn't count itself. Indestructible, and below red devotion 5 it isn't even a creature — it dodges creature removal and your own wipes.

Malakir Bloodwitch (ETB)

each opponent loses	=	$V \times RT \times BL$
you gain	=	$V \times RT \times BL \times P$ (the SUM across the table)

The biggest one-shot lifegain in the deck, and it feeds Blight-Priest for **1** event. At 8 Vampires with Bloodletter: 16 each, **48 for you**.

Twilight Prophet (upkeep)

each opponent loses	=	$M \times RT \times BL$ (M = revealed card's mana value)
you gain	=	$M \times RT$
		+ 1 card, every upkeep

Vito / Sanguine Bond

target opponent loses	=	$G \times BL$ — per life-gain EVENT, G = life gained that event
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Per **event**, same counting rule as Blight-Priest. The difference: **Vito and Sanguine Bond hit ONE opponent for the full amount; Blight-Priest hits ALL THREE for 1.**

The Meathook Massacre (static half)

each opponent loses	=	$D_y \times BL$
you gain	=	D_o

Sorin, Imperious Bloodlord (second +1)

sac a Vampire → 3 damage any target → 3 × BL
→ you gain 3 → Vito 3×BL + Blight-Priest 1×BL to each

4. Stats & combat

Any creature's real size

power = base + K + L + Shared Animosity bonus
toughness = base + K + L

Shared Animosity — the only quadratic in the deck

each attacker gets = $+(A - 1)/+0$
total power added = $A \times (A - 1)$

A=5 → +20. A=9 → +72. A=12 → +132.

Cathars' Crusade

counters on EACH creature you control = C (per creature entering)

Per Vampire spell cast:

without Elspeth → eminence token enters (+1 all) + the spell enters (+1 all) = +2/+2 board-wide
with Elspeth → 2 tokens + the spell = +3/+3 board-wide

⚠ It's a **triggered** ability, so its counters land *after* any enters-the-battlefield checks. That's why it never interferes with power-based ETB triggers.

Edgar Markov (attack trigger)

counters placed = $V \times RT$
team stats gained = +V/+V aggregate, permanently

Every Vampire, attacking or not. ⚠ RT applies only with Edgar **on the battlefield**.

Cordial Vampire

per creature death = $V \times RT$ counters placed

Counts **any** creature, opponents' included. ⚠ Counters land only on Vampires you control **when the trigger resolves** — survivors only.

Blade of the Bloodchief

per creature death = +1 counter on equipped (+2 if equipped creature is a Vampire)

Counts **any** death including opponents'. Equip 1. In a deck where creatures die every turn this is the fastest-growing thing on the board.

Indulgent Aristocrat

{2} + sac → V counters placed → +V/+V aggregate team stats

Instant speed. Use **after blockers are declared**.

Vampire Socialite

ETB → $V - 1$ counters placed
static → every Vampire enters with +1 extra counter

⚠ The static half is a **replacement effect** — the counter is there as the creature enters, before any ETB trigger checks its stats.

Yahenni, Undying Partisan

counters gained = Do (if Yahenni survives)

The lords (L)

Legion Lieutenant	+1/+1	
Captivating Vampire	+1/+1	
Stromkirk Captain	+1/+1	+ first strike
Markov Baron	+1/+1	+ lifelink
Edgar, Charmed Groom	+1/+1	
Patchwork Banner	+1/+1	(artifact, not a creature)
Warleader's Call	+1/+1	(ALL creatures, not just Vampires)
Lord of Lineage	+2/+2	(flipped Bloodline Keeper)
L max	+9/+9	

⚠ Every Vampire lord says "other" Vampires. No lord buffs itself. Patchwork Banner and Warleader's Call have no such restriction.

Knight of the Ebon Legion

{2}{B}	→ +3/+3 and deathtouch
end step	→ +1 counter if any player lost 4+ life

Vault of the Archangel

{2}{W}{B}, {T}	→ your whole team gains deathtouch AND lifelink until EOT
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With A attackers connecting, that's A separate life-gain events — see Blight-Priest above.

5. Token production (all x2 under Elspeth)

Source	Tokens	Notes
Edgar — eminence	1 / Vampire spell	Works from the command zone. x2 again with RT only if Edgar is on the battlefield
Bloodline Keeper	1 × 2/2 flier / turn	☞ ability — summoning sickness applies
Elenda — on death	= her power	1/1 lifelink Vampires
Clavileño	1 × 4/3 flier + a card	When the marked Vampire dies
Edgar Markov's Coffin	1 / upkeep	Flips back at 3 bloodline counters
Charismatic Conqueror	1 × 1/1 lifelink	When an opponent's artifact/creature enters untapped and they don't tap it
Black Market Connections	1 Treasure, 1 × 3/2	The 3/2 is a changeling — counts as a Vampire
Deadly Dispute	1 Treasure	Plus 2 cards
Elspeth +1	1 Soldier	⚠ Soldiers are not Vampires

Value of one Vampire spell

creatures entering	= 1 (the spell) + 1 × EL (eminence)
	= 2 without Elspeth, 3 with

6. Card draw

Card	Formula	Cost / catch
Scheming Silvertongue	2 / turn	Needs you to have gained 2+ life that turn. Lose 2 life
Florian, Voldaren Scion	look at top X, play 1	X = life all opponents lost this turn. Postcombat main only, use it that turn
Emeritus of Woe	tutor 1 → hand	Re-arms whenever 2+ creatures died that turn
Plumb the Forbidden	n cards for n creatures	Lose 1 life each. Instant — sac in response to a wrath
Deadly Dispute	2 + a Treasure	Sac an artifact or creature
Twilight Prophet	1 / upkeep	Free, plus the drain. Needs 10 permanents
Dusk Legion Duelist	1 / turn	Needs counters placed on it. Cathars' Crusade turns this on every turn
Black Market Connections	1 / turn	Lose 2 life. Modes are cumulative
Herald's Horn	1 / upkeep if it's a Vampire	Free look at the top card
Castle Locthwain	1	1☞☞, ☞, lose life = hand size <i>after</i> drawing
Minas Tirith	1	1*, ☞, only if you attacked with 2+
Path of Ancestry	scry 1	Free, when its mana casts a Vampire

The "prepared" mechanic — Emeritus of Woe & Scheming Silvertongue

Both enter **prepared**, letting you cast a **copy of their spell half**. Casting it unprepares them; they re-arm when their condition is met again:

Emeritus of Woe	re-arms if 2+ creatures died this turn	→ copy of Demonic Tutor {1}{B}
Scheming Silvertongue	re-arms if you gained 2+ life this turn	→ copy of Sign in Blood {B}{B}

Both conditions are near-automatic in this deck. The copy is **not** use-it-or-lose-it — cast it any time you could cast a sorcery while the creature stays prepared.

7. Sacrifice outlets

Outlet	Cost	Output
Viscera Seer	free	Scry 1
Ashnod's Altar	free	♦♦
Yahenni	free	Indestructible until EOT
Phyrexian Tower	free (☞)	☠☠
Master of Dark Rites	free (☞)	☠☠☠ — Vampire / Cleric / Demon spells only
Indulgent Aristocrat	2	V counters on your team
Plumb the Forbidden	1☠	1 card per creature — any number at once
Deadly Dispute	1☠	2 cards + a Treasure
Ruthless Lawbringer	ETB	Destroy target nonland permanent

Value of one sacrificed token

Blood Artist	→ 1 × BL	focusable
Cruel Celebrant	→ 1 × BL	to EACH opponent
Vein Ripper	→ 2 × BL	focusable
Mirkwood Bats	→ 1 × BL	to EACH opponent
Meathook Massacre	→ 1 × BL	to EACH opponent
Marauding Blight-Priest	→ 1 × BL	to EACH opponent, per lifegain EVENT the above cause
Cordial Vampire	→ V counters	
Blade of the Bloodchief	→ +2 counters on equipped	
Dictate of Erebos	→ each opponent sacrifices a creature	

With Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant + Mirkwood Bats + Vein Ripper, one 1/1 token is **~11 life off the table** before Bloodletter — free, instant speed, in response to anything.

8. Board wipes — picking X

The safe-X rule

safe X = (lowest toughness you want to keep) - 1
where toughness = base + K + L

Olivia's Wrath — your best wipe

each NON-Vampire gets -V/-V

⚠ Kills your own Mirkwood Bats and Elspeth's Soldiers. Safe: all Vampire tokens, the Black Market changeling, Roaming Throne *if you named Vampire*.

The Meathook Massacre

{X}{B}{B}	→ every creature gets -X/-X
	→ Dy × BL to each opponent
	→ Do life for you
	→ the drain half STAYS on the battlefield

Meathook is on the battlefield when its own ETB resolves, so it counts every death it causes.

Indestructible does not save a 0-toughness creature. Rule 704.5f — toughness 0 or less goes to the graveyard as a state-based action; indestructible only stops *destroy* and lethal damage.

Surviving someone else's wipe

Teferi's Protection	→	phase everything out; you keep the whole board
Plumb the Forbidden	→	sac the board in response, draw 6-8 (also beats EXILE wipes)
Akroma's Will	→	indestructible mode, if you control your commander
Yahenni	→	free indestructible for itself

9. Multiplicative pairs, ranked

×4 — Sanctum Seeker + Bloodletter + Roaming Throne

each opponent loses	=	A × 4
at A = 9	=	36 each, 108 across the table

Unblockable, uninteractable, on the declare-attackers step. **The biggest number in the deck.**

Alpha strike — Vault of the Archangel + Marauding Blight-Priest

A attackers with lifelink connect	
→ A separate life-gain events	
→ Blight-Priest: A to EACH opponent (×BL on your turn)	
→ Vito: full combat damage to ONE opponent (×BL)	
at A = 8 with Bloodletter	= 16 to each opponent from Blight-Priest alone

Deathtouch on the same activation means every blocker trades down.

Wipe — Meathook + Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant + Blight-Priest + Vito

per YOUR death	Meathook 1 each + Artist 1 focused + Celebrant 1 each
	→ 2 life-gain events → Blight-Priest 2 each
per THEIR death	Artist 1 focused + Vein Ripper 2 focused

At Dy = 7: 7 each from Meathook, 7 each from Celebrant, 14 each from Blight-Priest, plus 7 focusable from Blood Artist — **~28 to each opponent**, doubled on your turn by Bloodletter. **Pick X so Blight-Priest and Vito live.** Blood Artist dying is fine (look-back); they aren't.

Burst — Purphoros + Warleader's Call + Elspeth + eminence

cast 1 Vampire	→	3 creatures enter (spell + 2 doubled tokens)
Purphoros	→	3 × 2 = 6 to each
Warleader's Call	→	3 × 1 = 3 to each
		9 to each, 18 with Bloodletter
		54 across the table PER VAMPIRE CAST

(This was 12/36 when Impact Tremors was also in the deck — it was cut for Florian.)

Engine — free outlet + Blood Artist + Cruel Celebrant + Mirkwood Bats + Blight-Priest

per token sacrificed	=	1 focused + 1 each + 1 each + 2 each (Blight-Priest, 2 events)
	=	~13 across the table, ~26 with Bloodletter

Combat — Shared Animosity + wide board + Edgar's counters

total power	=	Σ(base + K + L) + A × (A - 1)
at A = 9, 1/1 tokens with 3 counters, L = 2	=	9×6 + 72 = 126 power

Lock — Dictate of Erebos + free sac outlet

Every token you sac makes **each** opponent sacrifice. Empties three boards in a turn while feeding Blood Artist, Cruel Celebrant, Vein Ripper and Blight-Priest.

Finisher — Vito's ☹☹☹ + wide attack

Team lifelink means every point of combat damage becomes an equal point of life loss via Vito, doubled again by Bloodletter — and each attacker is a **separate** Blight-Priest event on top. Add Akroma's Will's double strike and it doubles once more.

Grind — Yahenni / Cordial Vampire + your own board wipe

Yahenni	→	+Do counters	(a 15/15 at Do = 12)
Cordial Vampire	→	D × V counters	(on survivors only)

Value — Clavileño + Elspeth

Mark your worst token each combat: a card plus **two** 4/3 fliers when it dies.

Recursion — Phyrexian Reclamation

{1}{B} + 2 life	
→	creature from graveyard to HAND
→	recasting it re-triggers EMINENCE (another token)
→	and every ETB payoff again

Returns to hand, not the battlefield — that's the feature, not a drawback.

10. Rules gotchas worth memorising

Interaction	Ruling
Anthems and entering creatures	A token is never on the battlefield unmodified (CR 611.3c). Anthems apply as it enters, before any ETB trigger checks its stats
Vampire Socialite's counter	A replacement effect (CR 614.1d) — applied as the creature enters, so it counts toward power-based checks
Cathars' Crusade counters	A triggered ability — lands after ETB checks, so it never affects them
Lifelink triggers	Multiple lifelink sources dealing damage simultaneously = separate life-gain events (CR 702.15e). One source hitting many things = one event
Dies-triggers look back	Blood Artist / Cruel Celebrant trigger even if they died in the same wipe (CR 603.10a). "Whenever you gain life" does NOT — Blight-Priest and Vito must survive
Toughness 0	Goes to the graveyard as an SBA (704.5f). Indestructible doesn't save it
Eminence	Triggers on cast , from the command zone. Reanimation and "put onto the battlefield" effects miss it entirely